



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy of Corinth
School Website: <https://www.founderscorinth.com/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy - Corinth (FCA Corinth) demonstrates a robust classical orientation across multiple dimensions, with strong alignment to key elements of classical education (great books, liberal arts, virtuous formation, and a living-faculty culture). The public materials on FCA Corinth emphasize truth, beauty, and goodness as central ideals, a knowledge-rich liberal arts curriculum, explicit study of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, a faculty culture that highlights virtue-named roles and mentorship, and active partnership with families. The aggregate assessment across the six classical criteria is CLASSICAL, with Element 2 (Purpose & Goal), Element 3 (Curriculum), Element 5 (Faculty), and Element 6 (Parents & Community) scoring strongly CLASSICAL, Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing partial alignment, and Element 4 in particular reflecting some gaps in explicitly described Socratic pedagogy. The school shows meaningful evidence of Great Books, Latin studies, memory-like curricular rhythms, and a living-teacher model, coupled with explicit parental partnership. The primary gaps relate to explicit theological grounding and liturgical practices, and a clearly articulated high-school-level Socratic pedagogy depiction beyond general classical phrasing.

- Evidence syntheses draw on FCA Corinth public materials, including statements about a classical liberal arts curriculum oriented toward truth, beauty, and goodness; explicit Great Books emphasis; grammar, logic, and rhetoric; Latin instruction; a knowledge-rich curriculum; and the presence of virtue-named faculty and parent/community partnering language. See sources such as Our Curriculum and Our Program sections, mission statements, and faculty pages for concrete language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The public materials emphasize an orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness as guiding ideals of classical education. This aligns with transcendental moral realism insofar as these are treated as enduring aims.
 - Virtue and moral formation are repeatedly foregrounded (formation of virtuous citizens; pursuit of knowledge to promote virtue).
 - There is no explicit, stated grounding in a particular theology, liturgical practice, or formal theology integration in the described program from the publicly available pages. This reflects a lack of explicit theological grounding in the materials reviewed.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue. These are foregrounded in FCA Corinth's messaging.
 - Negative keywords observed: none explicitly evident in the public materials (e.g., "secular humanism," "relativism" are not deployed as signals here). The absence of explicit theology or liturgy is a gap relative to a robust "Religious and Metaphysical Foundations" emphasis in classical lexicons.
- Why this rating

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- The school clearly centers on the transcendent aims of truth, goodness, and beauty and virtue, which are core positive signals for a classical orientation. However, the lack of explicit theological grounding or liturgical practices in the public materials means it does not fully meet the liturgical/theological benchmarks. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school explicitly states that the goal of public education is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people, prepared to flourish—an explicit formation/virtue telos rather than mere information acquisition. It treats education as formation of character and human excellence.
 - The program emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of human excellence, not primarily job-readiness, echoing the classical paideia aim.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, classical mission, telos, true/good/beautiful (as conceptual signals).
 - Negative keywords observed: none evident (no strong emphasis on workforce-centric framing in the public messaging).
- Why this rating
 - FCA Corinth frames education as formation toward virtue and wisdom and asserts a classical mission beyond mere job preparation. This aligns strongly with the Classical category’s aims for Purpose and Goal, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit reference to a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; emphasis on minds-on learning; not driven by standardized tests).
 - Strong emphasis on Great Books (primary sources and Great Books) and the Great Conversation; Latin and Greek root study; historical grounding of science; civics through classical literacy.
 - The curriculum highlights the liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the inclusion of classical languages (Latin from Grade 3–5 onward).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classical languages (Latin/Greek), Western civilization/history, arts (theory/history/performance), memory/close reading.
 - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none in the public-facing materials (no replacement of history with “social studies”; no heavy emphasis on project-based learning dominating the curriculum).
- Why this rating
 - The explicit articulation of a grammar–logic–rhetoric foundation, Great Books emphasis, and Latin/Greek language study, plus history anchored in Western civilization, constitutes a strong CLASSICAL curriculum signal.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The program describes a classical approach with a traditional liberal arts framework and a focus on virtues, but explicit descriptions of high-school Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates are not clearly documented in the public materials. The materials emphasize “whole-group teaching” and memory-friendly practices in a virtue-centric framework, with a living curriculum through dedicated faculty.
 - There are concrete examples of a memory/recitation orientation in lower grades (not explicitly shown as chant or memory drills on the site, but “habits of virtues” and civility are described). The

existence of upper-school rhetoric and public speaking is implied in emphasizing logic, rhetoric, and senior projects, but explicit Socratic pedagogy is not clearly described in the high school content.

- A campus culture that uses house systems and advisory periods exists (Grammar Upper Campus structure, house sorting), indicating communal and reflective pedagogy rather than a solely drill-based model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive signals observed: habits of virtue, civility, self-government, contemplation/restful learning (scholé-like resonances), memory work concepts in the curriculum narrative.
 - Negative signals observed: limited explicit articulation of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the high school; explicit project-based or experiential learning orientation is not foregrounded in the public-facing materials.
- Why this rating
 - The school clearly embraces classical pedagogy elements (memory, virtue formation, grammar/-logic/rhetoric emphasis) but lacks explicit, high-visibility statements about Socratic seminars, debates, or scholé days in the publicly available materials for the upper grades. This yields a SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The faculty appears to be central to the school's identity, with signs of virtue-led leadership and living examples of classical education. The staff pages show teachers identified with virtue-naming (e.g., Temperantia, Prudentia, Fortitudo) and multiple teacher profiles, indicating a living-curriculum ethos and mentorship culture. Examples include HS Math: Temperantia and 1st Grade: Prudentia; staff contact pages.
 - The public materials emphasize partnership between teachers and students, and a portrait-oriented, collegial culture, consistent with the classical living-curriculum model. The curriculum also frames teachers as moral exemplars within the school.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, masters/mentors/guide-like framing, collegial culture, virtue-driven teacher identity (Temperantia/Prudentia/Fortitudo).
 - Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in the public materials (no explicit “certification-driven” or “facilitator/guide on the side” language).
- Why this rating
 - The presence of virtue-named faculty and a visible living-curriculum approach, plus explicit teacher profiles, strongly supports CLASSICAL for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The materials foreground partnership with families and a shared educational mission. The messaging invites parental partnership and frames education as a collaboration with parents (e.g., “partnering with you in the education of your scholar”).
 - The campus messaging emphasizes a small-school, cooperative atmosphere where parents, faculty, and staff work together for the benefit of each child; this resonates with the classical emphasis on parent formation and family involvement.
 - The broader FCA Corinth site includes “Meet the Patriots” and campus-life content (house systems, campus culture) that supports parent engagement and community formation, consistent with the classical community model.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers with the school, parental formation, open campus ideas, family involvement, home-school/community alignment.

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- Negative keywords observed: none clearly present in the public-facing materials (no consumer/customer framing of parents; instead a partnership framing is present).
 - Why this rating
 - The school's messaging emphasizes parental partnership and family engagement, with a culture of community involvement, supporting a CLASSICAL rating for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Ranking

- Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, FCA Corinth is CLASSICAL. The strongest signals lie in Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with robust alignment to Great Books, liberal arts, virtue formation, and living-teacher models. Element 1 shows partial alignment due to the absence of explicit theological or liturgical grounding in the public materials, and Element 4 shows partial alignment due to a lack of clearly described high-school Socratic pedagogy in the public materials (even though memory, virtue formation, and a traditional pedagogy are present). Taken together, the school demonstrates a classical education orientation with meaningful fidelity to the core elements while showing some gaps in explicit theological/liturgical framing and explicit Socratic pedagogy in the high-school context.

Executive Summary — notes: - Great Books, liberal arts core, Latin/Greek study, memory-oriented components, and a living-faculty culture are present and well-aligned with classical education. - The left-out theological/festal liturgical elements and explicit high-school Socratic pedagogy are gaps to watch for in continuous improvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Introduce explicit, canonical theological framing or liturgical practices in public materials to clearly anchor transcendental moral realism and sacred dimensions within the school's classical identity, while maintaining a secular public-school status if required by charter laws. This would strengthen the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices signals.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit articulation of high-school level Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the public-facing materials, with examples of seminars, debates, or Paideia-style discussions in 9–12 programs. Include examples of Scholé days or contemplative rests to demonstrate the contemplative/restful aspect of pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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